

EL TORBELLINO

NEWSLETTER OF SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS FREE FLIGHT CLUB



April 2026

The Prez's Corner – Don Bartick

Well as your president, I'm supposed to lead off the El Torbellino with words of wisdom. I'm not sure where they come from. I'll look at the bottom of a Cracker Jack box. Maybe there. No, not there. Okay, the burden is on me. Here goes.

As I reflect on the past, I think of the Orbiteer flying at our Otay Mesa field. Beautiful rolling hills of short wild grass. One half mile from the boarder. How many times during the chase of a model, we would come across Boarder Patrol after a group of migrants that crossed the border illegally. We could watch the whole thing play out. Like cat and mouse. It was great to have the Boarder Patrol around. Many times, they helped us find our planes. The club forbid the use of motor bikes to chase, because of property destruction, potential fire and most importantly, disturbance of the Burling Owl. John Oldenkamp really championed the protection of that endangered species. In fact, we prohibited the use of fuse DT systems. Unfortunately, we lost the field to development after 30+ years. No other field in SW San Diego County has yet to be found to serve our purpose, even after an exhaustive search. So, we moved to Perris to share the SCAMPS field. Made the drive much longer, but we do what we have to do in order to enjoy the hobby that is so dear to us. In years past, fields were never an issue. But with population growth, developers bought up the land and pushed the Free Flight community in Southern CA out. The saga continues as we now witness the Perris field about to be developed. Where now we ask. I don't know. For me, I'm willing to go to Lost Hills to fly in contests 3 times a year. Also, to Eloy & Buckeye, AZ 1 time each. See, I'm a contest guy. I love competition. It's not for everyone. Nothing wrong with being a sport flyer, but that's not me. I'm in my winter years. So, chasing fields is not a priority for me. Getting up in the morning ranks high. Arline and I will be going to the AMA Nationals in Muncie, IN this year. Most likely for the last time. My primary reason is to visit the National Model Airplane Museum that's on site. I want to see in person the P-30 Exhibit that I spearhead the development along with museum Director, Michael Smith over a 15-month period. Then I'll get in the competition spirit. Enough rambling.

I just completed the build of an original 1/2A-A gas model patterned after my High-tail P-30. It shares the same wing and tail geometry plus airfoil. Just scaled up to 320 sq in. Powered by either a Cyclone .049 or .061. Should be a rocket ship. I'll find out at Perris when we have our next contest.

That's a wrap.

Remember: Today is the tomorrow you worried about yesterday.

Author unknown.



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Mike Jester' P18 taking a pit stop →

ORBITEERS MEMBERSHIP DUES

Annual Membership - \$20
Lifetime Membership - \$250
Non-Member Newsletter Subscription - \$15
Junior Members 16 years old or younger - Free

Submit Dues to Club Treasurer:

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3860 Ecochee Avenue
San Diego, CA 92117-4622

THE FINE PRINT THE FINE PRINT

El Torbellino is the official newsletter of the San Diego Orbiteers, an Academy of Model Aeronautics (AMA) Charter Club (#1113) and a California not for Profit Corporation. This newsletter is sent monthly to all paid members, selected exchange and magazine editors. Non-Members may subscribe at \$15.00 per year within the U.S.A., offshore price will be adjusted to reflect the postage required. Materials from El Torbellino may be reproduced on an unlimited basis by other publications, but proper credit is requested.

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www.SanDiegoOrbiteers.com

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Kokusai KI-128 Ta-Go

By Mike Jester

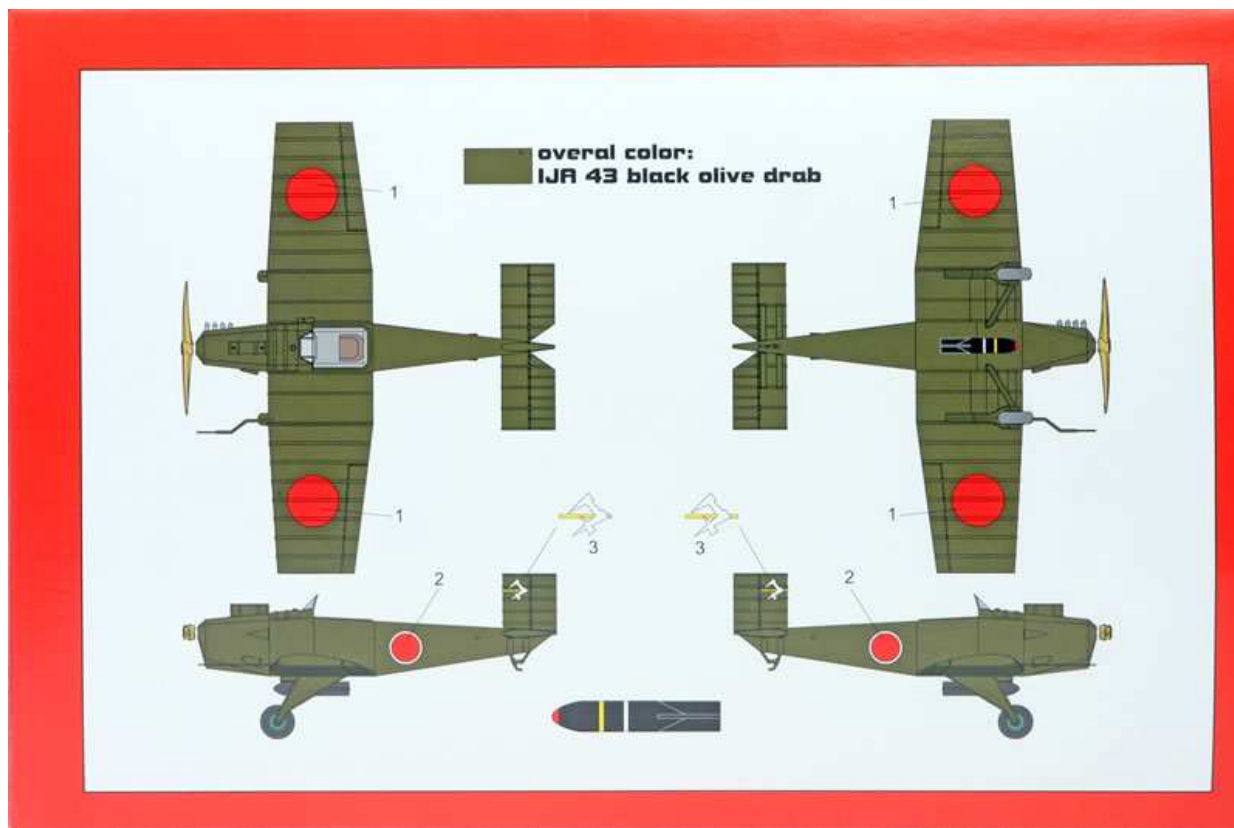
For those of you that like to build stick and tissue scale models, consider the Kokusai KI-128 Ta-Go. It was a mostly wood “Special Attack” (kamikaze) airplane. It was rapidly developed in desperation by the Japanese Army in 1945 in the hopes of thwarting an invasion of the main Japanese islands by US forces. Out-of-the-box armaments are sometimes developed in a war being fought for survival. The pilot sat in an open cockpit equipped with a simple wind screen instead of a canopy. Besides its 4-cylinder 110 HP air cooled engine, other metal components of this airplane were the fuel tank and the engine mount. The fuel tank was mounted on top of the nose. This allowed for gravity feeding of gasoline to the engine, eliminating the need for a fuel pump. The Ta-Go had metal landing gear and control cables. The landing gear was designed to drop out from underneath the wing on takeoff under the force of gravity in order to lessen drag and weight. The landing gear would not be needed for a return landing. There was only one fully completed prototype and only one test flight, with the landing gear remaining fixed to the airplane. The test pilot reported that the handling of the prototype was not good. Unknown modifications were made to improve handling. The Ta-Go was supposed to carry a single 100 KG bomb strapped to the fuselage. The bomb would not be released as the airplane would be flown into its target. Flying at only a little over 100 mph it would have been an easy target for 50 BMG machine guns on US Navy ships and fighter airplanes. However, it was very inexpensive and did not require strategically valuable materials or components. The Ta-Go might have been effective in swarm attacks. But it was developed too late in WWII, only months before the Japanese surrendered to the allies in August 1945.



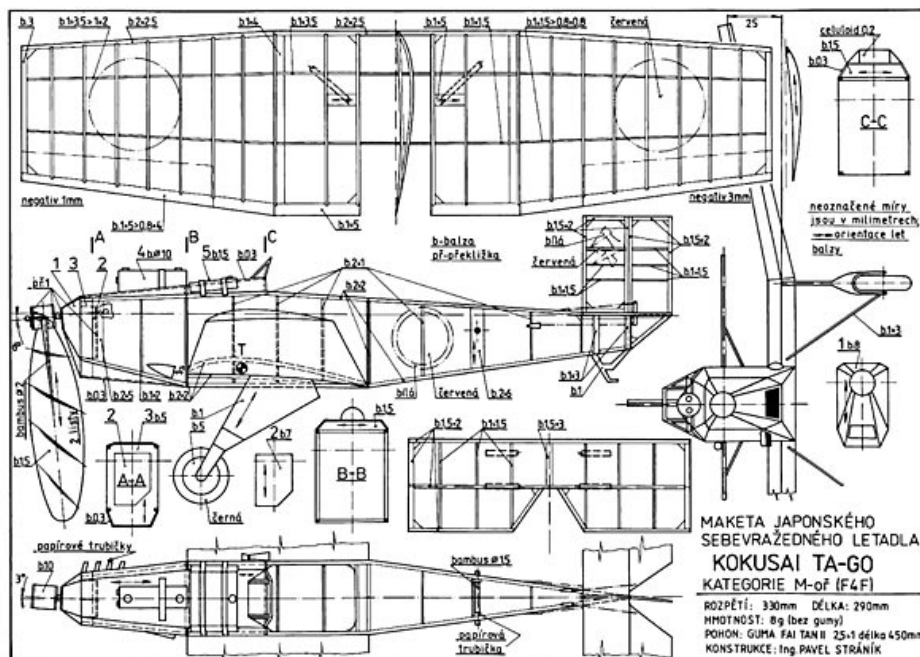
Kokusai KI-128 Ta-Go

Several years ago, I purchased a laser-cut short kit for the Ta-Go from Volare Products. The excellent plan indicates a quick and easy build due to the airplane's square lines. This 16-inch wing span Volare Products model is eligible for competition in the FAC Dime Scale event. It has the proportions to be a good flyer if built around 20 grams. I would build in the maximum wing dihedral permitted under the FAC rules and trim it to fly left-left. Landing gear need not be included on the model to fly in the FAC Dime Scale event. I would not incorporate a DT as this model would have a small risk of an out-of-sight fly away. It would not present a huge loss in building time or materials if it was lost. I have some green tissue for

covering my Ta-Go model and some red tissue for the meatball roundels. The green color scheme indicates to me that the Japanese Army did not intend to use this kamikaze weapon over blue waters of the Pacific Ocean. The simple Ta-Go airplane is definitely on my build list.



Kokusai KI-128 Ta-Go Colors and Roundels



March 2026 SDO Contest Results

8 Official fliers (As reported by M.Pykelyny)

OT/NOS/Jimmie Allen

1st- Matt K 356

2nd- David 352

3rd- Mike P 200

Glider- HLG

1st Stan 360

2nd- Chris 261

3rd- John M 60

Power- E-36

1st- Stan 360

2nd- Clint 345

3rd- Don 311

Next Contest April 19th



Photo's by Arline Bartick

March 2026 SDO Contest Results
8 Official fliers (As reported by M.Pykelyny)



Photo's by Arline Bartick

Return to Indoor Flying---Don Bartick



April 12th marked the 7th time that we have flown Indoors at the Los Coches Creek Middle School gym. The 2 competitions were Embryo and P-18.

Six flyers registered and 6 entered the events. 3 in Embryo and 4 in P-18. The best 3 of 6 official attempts were scored and added together. The results were:

Embryo

1 st Don Bartick	117 seconds
2 nd Walter Ainslie	112 seconds
3 rd Robert Huffstutler	71 seconds

P-18

1 st Greg Hutchison	402 seconds
2 nd Mike Jester	342 seconds
3 rd Don Bartick	320 seconds
4 th Walter Ainslie	117 seconds



The 6 participants contributed \$310 towards the \$318 rental fee. I ask for a minimum contribution of \$30 for the 4-hour session. As you can see, the participant reached deep in their pockets. Some more than others. This proves how important it is to some to have the opportunity to fly indoors. But we need more participation. If you're willing to travel to Perris to fly outdoor FF knowing the weather or field conditions could be iffy, then you should be willing to go to El Cajon to fly indoors knowing that there isn't an issue with weather or field conditions. Plus, the chases are darn easy. The challenge, in my opinion is more difficult.

The gym is the best indoor venue we have ever had. With a 27-foot height to the center girder. Higher if you fly above the wooden girders. Some successfully do. It makes indoor flying a joy. So, everyone reading this report, please try indoor or return to indoor.

Next Indoor is scheduled for June 7th for 4 hours-8am to noon. Minimum contribution to participate is \$30. Additional contributions are welcomed or may be needed. Competition events are free. Events will be Limited Penny Plane and Phantom Flash. Of course, bring whatever you have to fun fly.

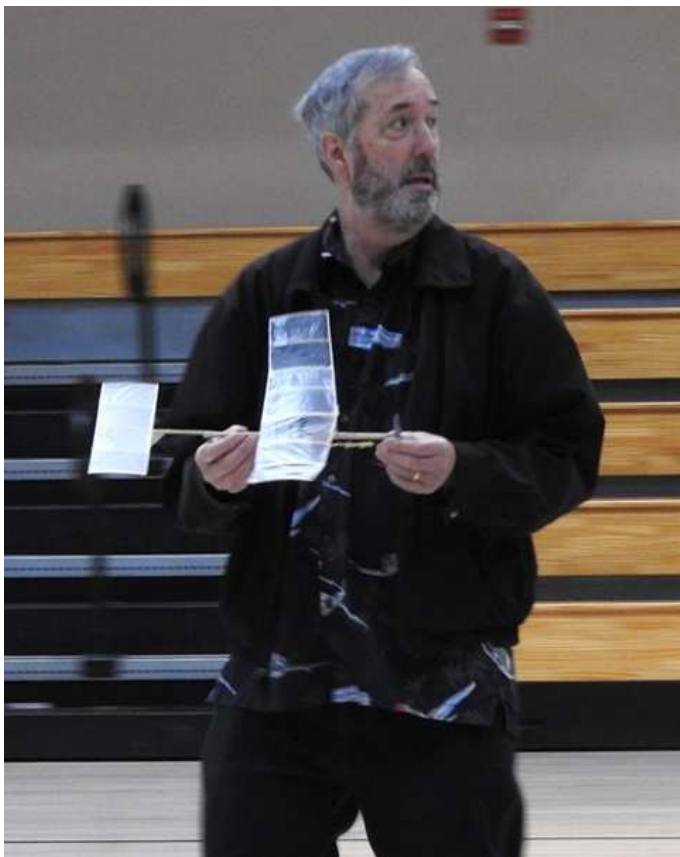
WE NEED MORE PARTICIPANTS. We can't sustain renting this great venue without more participants. Please consider Indoor Free Flight. It's really a fun version of Free Flight.

Up-up and away!

Don



Return to Indoor Flying---Don Bartick



Photo's by Arline Bartick

A Stan Buddenbolm Original Poem

Twass the morning before Christmas,
and all across the field,
only one creature was stirring,
and it wasn't a mouse.

As the sun was just peaking,
the dawn's early light,
Stan was unpacking,
preparing first flight.

But up in the dim,
coming down out of night,
were several young chutists,
having jumped from a height.

Stan held back his launch,
letting all the men land,
they were laughing and crying,
their day was just grand.



More Indoor Pictures from April 2026



Photo's by Arline Bartick

San Diego Orbiteers Flying Schedule 2026 Taibi Field Perris, Ca

<u>Primary Date</u>	<u>Rain Date</u>	<u>Event</u>
April 19	April 26	P-30 /Glider/Power
May 17	May 24	Coupe/Glider/Power
June 14	June 28	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
July 19	July 26	P-30/Glider/Power
August 16	Aug 23	Coupe/Glider/Power
September Hills, Ca	(TBD)	Free Flight Championships, Lost
September 20	September 27	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
October 18	October 25	P-30/Glider/Power
November	13,14&15	Dual Clubs, Lost Hill, Ca
November 22	November 29	Coupe/Glider/Power
December 13	No Date	Make-up

MP
12/25



May 2026 Outdoor Contest

May 23 and 24

7 a.m. Set up

8 a.m. Pilots meeting

11:30 a.m. Last flight

CD: William Scott

wscott127@mac.com
(619) 701-2457

Studio 6 Suites
480 South Redlands
Perris, CA 92571
(951) 943-5577



Saturday 8 a.m. Pilot's meeting

Saturday's Mass Launches

WW 1: Sponsorship Available

8:30 a.m. WWI Mass Launch Photo

8:35 a.m. WWI Mass Launch

WW II: Sponsorship Available

9:30 a.m. WWII Mass Launch Photo

9:35 a.m. WWII Mass Launch

Sunday 8 a.m Pilot's meeting

Sunday's Mass Launches

Greve/Thompson Sponsorship Available

8:30 a.m. Greve/Thompson Mass Launch Photo

8:35 a.m. Greve/Thompson Mass Launch

Phantom Flash Sponsored by William Scott

9:30 a.m. Phantom Flash Mass Launch Photo

9:35 a.m. Phantom Flash Mass Launch

Fly Either Day*

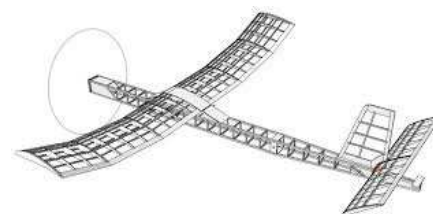
1. FAC Rubber Scale **Sponsored by Anonymous**
2. Embryo Endurance (ROG) **Sponsored by William Scott**
3. Golden Aged Combined
4. Old Time Rubber Stick and Fuselag (hand launched)
5. FAC 2Bit +1 and Jimmy Allen combined (ROG)
6. Phantom Flash (ROG)
7. Jet Catapult

*All flights must be made on the same day.

Web site

<https://sites.google.com/view/scalestaffel/home>

SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS
Howard L. Haupt / Editor
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San Diego, California 92117-4266



WHAT'S HAPPENING -

- April 19, 2026 - San Diego Orbiteer Outdoor Monthly
 Taibi Flying Field, Perris CA, 7:30 start time.
 Events: **P-30, Glider, Power**
- May 23 / 24 - Scale Staffel Outdoor Contest
 Taibi Flying Field, Perris CA, 7:00 start time.
 See enclose contest flyer for schedule and events.

